



Jacket SHORTAGES in the Paramilitary Forces

➤ Sanctioned 2.09 lakh jackets	➤ Shortage
	CRPF 40,000
	CISF 15,127
➤ Need 87,000 jackets	ITBP 8,216
	NSG 1,725

THE CBI IS PROBING CORRUPTION CHARGES in the fast-track acquisition of 20,000 bulletproof jackets after the 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks.



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GUPTA (LEFT) AND HIS WIFE LAVEENA BEING PRODUCED IN A COURT IN DELHI

is the lawyer in a petition demanding accountability in Karkare's case.

Curiously, the payment for Sharma's services was made not last year after Anjani had supplied the jackets, but just last month. This was around the time Anjani lost out on a Rs 103-crore deal to buy 59,000 bul-

letproof jackets for paramilitary forces fighting Maoists. The contract, slated to increase by another 14,750 jackets, would become one of the largest in recent years. Yet for a firm that had just supplied the MHA with enough jackets to equip 20 battalions of soldiers, Anjani failed to make the

grade. In tests conducted at the Defence Research and Development Organisation's (DRDO) Terminal Ballistics Research Laboratory (TBRL), three of its samples were rejected after they failed to stop AK-47 bullets.

Officials say it was eerily reminiscent of a 2008 case of failed bulletproof jackets which had been supplied to the CRPF in Jammu and Kashmir. In early 2008, the CRPF had doubts on the quality of the jackets supplied by private manufacturers. Three random samples were pulled out and tested against AK-47s. All the jackets lay in tatters. Apparently, none of them could withstand the AK-47 rounds which they had been tested and certified against. A worried IG (Operations) Maithili Sharan Gupta dashed off a two-page report to CRPF headquarters in Delhi. The gist: he would not allow his men to wear unsafe jackets. Nothing came of the report and the CRPF went back to wearing the jackets.

Several lots of apparently tested and certified bulletproof jackets were found faulty by the Assam Rifles in